

IMAGE PROMPTS — VISUAL REFERENCE

The One Decision That Defeats All Three Brain Traps

89 beats · 3 parts of max 30 beats · Visual-first (no redundant text labels)

STYLE PREAMBLE — prepend to every prompt in Google Flow:

2D flat cartoon illustration, thick solid black outlines, clean solid color fills, no gradients. ALEX: large beige oval head, transparent glass upper skull revealing pink cartoon brain villain inside, small black dot eyes, thin neutral mouth, black spiky hair, blue t-shirt, gray pants. Brain villain: pink cartoon brain character, heavy-lidded eyes, slight smirk, small teeth. Palette: beige skin (#F5E6C8), pink brain (#E8A598), blue shirt, gray pants, green for savings/gains, red for loss/danger, white for diagram scenes. 16:9, 1280x720.

IMAGE PROMPTS — PART 1 (Beats 1–30)

■■ HOOK ■■

BEAT 1 *"There is one decision that defeats all three brain traps."*

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BEAT 2 *"Not a budget."*

Image Prompt: 2D flat cartoon illustration, thick solid black outlines, clean solid color fills, no gradients. ALEX: large beige oval head, transparent glass upper skull revealing pink cartoon brain villain inside, small black dot eyes, thin neutral mouth, black spiky hair, blue t-shirt, gray pants. Brain villain: pink cartoon brain character, heavy-lidded eyes, slight smirk, small teeth. Palette: beige skin (#F5E6C8), pink brain (#E8A598), blue shirt, gray pants, green for savings/gains, red for loss/danger, white for diagram scenes. 16:9, 1280x720. White background. Budget spreadsheet icon centered. Bold red X strikes through it instantly.

BEAT 3 *"Not discipline."*

Image Prompt: 2D flat cartoon illustration, thick solid black outlines, clean solid color fills, no gradients. ALEX: large beige oval head, transparent glass upper skull revealing pink cartoon brain villain inside, small black dot eyes, thin neutral mouth, black spiky hair, blue t-shirt, gray pants. Brain villain: pink cartoon brain character, heavy-lidded eyes, slight smirk, small teeth. Palette: beige skin (#F5E6C8), pink brain (#E8A598), blue shirt, gray pants, green for savings/gains, red for loss/danger, white for diagram scenes. 16:9, 1280x720. White background. Flexing arm / medal icon. Bold red X strikes through it.

BEAT 4 *"Not a savings app."*

Image Prompt: 2D flat cartoon illustration, thick solid black outlines, clean solid color fills, no gradients. ALEX: large beige oval head, transparent glass upper skull revealing pink cartoon brain villain inside, small black dot eyes, thin neutral mouth, black spiky hair, blue t-shirt, gray pants. Brain villain: pink cartoon brain character, heavy-lidded eyes, slight smirk, small teeth. Palette: beige skin (#F5E6C8), pink brain (#E8A598), blue shirt, gray pants, green for savings/gains, red for loss/danger, white for diagram scenes. 16:9, 1280x720. White background. Smartphone with app interface. Bold red X strikes through it.

BEAT 5 *"One bank transfer. Set up once. Takes three minutes."*

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BEAT 6 *"And it fires before your brain gets a vote."*

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BEAT 7 "Researchers tested this on four thousand workers. Starting savings rate: three and a half percent. Five years later: thirteen point six. Zero additional decisions."

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BEAT 8 "The Reward Trap. Mental Accounting. Present Bias. One decision — all three. Gone."

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BEAT 9 "In this video: exactly how it works — and the one move your brain will make to talk you out of it."

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BEAT 10 "It knows this video exists."

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■■ THE DEMONSTRATION ■■

BEAT 11 "Last Friday, Alex's salary arrived at 9:14 in the morning."

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BEAT 12 "By 9:15, four hundred euros were already gone."

Image Prompt: 2D flat cartoon illustration, thick solid black outlines, clean solid color fills, no gradients. ALEX: large beige oval head, transparent glass upper skull revealing pink cartoon brain villain inside, small black dot eyes, thin neutral mouth, black spiky hair, blue t-shirt, gray pants. Brain villain: pink cartoon brain character, heavy-lidded eyes, slight smirk, small teeth. Palette: beige skin (#F5E6C8), pink brain (#E8A598), blue shirt, gray pants, green for savings/gains, red for loss/danger, white for diagram scenes. 16:9, 1280x720. Close-up of phone screen. Balance changed: 3,200 is now 2,800. A completed transfer line below: STANDING ORDER — €400. Timestamp: 9:15. Clean. Already done.

BEAT 13 "Not on rent. Not on an impulse. Not on anything his brain had been planning."

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BEAT 14 "Four hundred euros moved before his brain registered the number."

Image Prompt: 2D flat cartoon illustration, thick solid black outlines, clean solid color fills, no gradients. ALEX: large beige oval head, transparent glass upper skull revealing pink cartoon brain villain inside, small black dot eyes, thin neutral mouth, black spiky hair, blue t-shirt, gray pants. Brain villain: pink cartoon brain character, heavy-lidded eyes, slight smirk, small teeth. Palette: beige skin (#F5E6C8), pink brain (#E8A598), blue shirt, gray pants, green for savings/gains, red for loss/danger, white for diagram scenes. 16:9, 1280x720. Close-up inside Alex's transparent skull. Villain mid-stretch — waking up, eyes half-open. Outside the skull: a small TRANSFER COMPLETE notification already fading. The villain missed the window entirely.

BEAT 15 "His brain had no vote."

Image Prompt: 2D flat cartoon illustration, thick solid black outlines, clean solid color fills, no gradients. ALEX: large beige oval head, transparent glass upper skull revealing pink cartoon brain villain inside, small black dot eyes, thin neutral mouth, black spiky hair, blue t-shirt, gray pants. Brain villain: pink cartoon brain character, heavy-lidded eyes, slight smirk, small teeth. Palette: beige skin (#F5E6C8), pink brain (#E8A598), blue shirt, gray pants, green for savings/gains, red for loss/danger, white for diagram scenes. 16:9, 1280x720. Wide shot, white background. A meeting room. Villain at the table, hand raised to vote. On the table: a large VOTE CLOSED stamp, ink still fresh. The decision predated this meeting entirely.

BEAT 16 "One standing order. Set up nine days earlier."

Image Prompt: 2D flat cartoon illustration, thick solid black outlines, clean solid color fills, no gradients. ALEX: large beige oval head, transparent glass upper skull revealing pink cartoon brain villain inside, small black dot eyes, thin neutral mouth, black spiky hair, blue t-shirt, gray pants. Brain villain: pink cartoon brain character, heavy-lidded eyes, slight smirk, small teeth. Palette: beige skin (#F5E6C8), pink brain (#E8A598), blue shirt, gray pants, green for savings/gains, red for loss/danger, white for diagram scenes. 16:9, 1280x720. Close-up of a calendar. A Sunday circled in green — nine days before payday. A standing order icon pinned to that Sunday. A dotted line connecting it forward to the following Friday.

BEAT 17 "Before the Reward Trap. Before Mental Accounting. Before Present Bias."

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BEAT 18 "In the last video, we showed you the three programs. This is the counter-program."

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BEAT 19 "This is it."

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■■ WHY KNOWING ISN'T ENOUGH ■■

BEAT 20 "Here's the part Alex got wrong."

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BEAT 21 "He watched the last video. He took notes. He sent it to his brother."

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BEAT 22 "He understood exactly why his brain spent the money."

Image Prompt: 2D flat cartoon illustration, thick solid black outlines, clean solid color fills, no gradients. ALEX: large beige oval head, transparent glass upper skull revealing pink cartoon brain villain inside, small black dot eyes, thin neutral mouth, black spiky hair, blue t-shirt, gray pants. Brain villain: pink cartoon brain character, heavy-lidded eyes, slight smirk, small teeth. Palette: beige skin (#F5E6C8), pink brain (#E8A598), blue shirt, gray pants, green for savings/gains, red for loss/danger, white for diagram scenes. 16:9, 1280x720. Medium shot. Alex at a whiteboard. The Reward Trap mechanism drawn correctly from memory. Villain inside skull crosses its arms — mildly impressed against its will.

BEAT 23 "He felt something shift — the specific feeling of finally getting it."

Image Prompt: 2D flat cartoon illustration, thick solid black outlines, clean solid color fills, no gradients. ALEX: large beige oval head, transparent glass upper skull revealing pink cartoon brain villain inside, small black dot eyes, thin neutral mouth, black spiky hair, blue t-shirt, gray pants. Brain villain: pink cartoon brain character, heavy-lidded eyes, slight smirk, small teeth. Palette: beige skin (#F5E6C8), pink brain (#E8A598), blue shirt, gray pants, green for savings/gains, red for loss/danger, white for diagram scenes. 16:9, 1280x720. Close-up of Alex's face. A quiet, precise expression: recognition. Not triumph. The relief of a pattern clicking into place. Villain inside skull looks slightly alarmed — for the first time.

BEAT 24 "And on Friday, the salary notification arrived."

Image Prompt: 2D flat cartoon illustration, thick solid black outlines, clean solid color fills, no gradients. ALEX: large beige oval head, transparent glass upper skull revealing pink cartoon brain villain inside, small black dot eyes, thin neutral mouth, black spiky hair, blue t-shirt, gray pants. Brain villain: pink cartoon brain character, heavy-lidded eyes, slight smirk, small teeth. Palette: beige skin (#F5E6C8), pink brain (#E8A598), blue shirt, gray pants, green for savings/gains, red for loss/danger, white for diagram scenes. 16:9, 1280x720. Close-up of Alex's phone. Familiar green notification. Same timestamp. Same green glow. The trigger the whiteboard diagram was about.

BEAT 25 "His brain asked: what do I deserve?"

Image Prompt: 2D flat cartoon illustration, thick solid black outlines, clean solid color fills, no gradients. ALEX: large beige oval head, transparent glass upper skull revealing pink cartoon brain villain inside, small black dot eyes, thin neutral mouth, black spiky hair, blue t-shirt, gray pants. Brain villain: pink cartoon brain character, heavy-lidded eyes, slight smirk, small teeth. Palette: beige skin (#F5E6C8), pink brain (#E8A598), blue shirt, gray pants, green for savings/gains, red for loss/danger, white for diagram scenes. 16:9, 1280x720. Close-up inside Alex's transparent skull. Villain — wide awake, eyes sharp — holds up its sign: 'WHAT DO I DESERVE?' Warm amber. The whiteboard diagram still visible in background, ignored.

BEAT 26 "The same question. The same Friday. The same amount gone."

Image Prompt: 2D flat cartoon illustration, thick solid black outlines, clean solid color fills, no gradients. ALEX: large beige oval head, transparent glass upper skull revealing pink cartoon brain villain inside, small black dot eyes, thin neutral mouth, black spiky hair, blue t-shirt, gray pants. Brain villain: pink cartoon brain character, heavy-lidded eyes, slight smirk, small teeth. Palette: beige skin (#F5E6C8), pink brain (#E8A598), blue shirt, gray pants, green for savings/gains, red for loss/danger, white for diagram scenes. 16:9, 1280x720. Wide split panel. LEFT: last Friday (before the video). RIGHT: this Friday (after the video). Both panels identical — same notification, same villain, same balance change. No labels. The silence says it.

BEAT 27 "Knowing the name of a trap does not move the walls."

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BEAT 28 "Every finance book gives Alex the diagnosis. None of them give him the surgery."

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BEAT 29 "Because the surgery requires removing the decision — not improving it."

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■■ WHY WILLPOWER FAILS ■■

BEAT 30 "Roy Baumeister — social psychologist at Florida State University —"

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PART 1 DONE — Beats 1–30 ✓

IMAGE PROMPTS — PART 2 (Beats 31–60)

BEAT 31 "spent a decade measuring something he calls ego depletion."

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BEAT 32 "Willpower is not a character trait. It is a finite resource."

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BEAT 33 "It depletes with every decision made — not just financial ones."

Image Prompt: 2D flat cartoon illustration, thick solid black outlines, clean solid color fills, no gradients. ALEX: large beige oval head, transparent glass upper skull revealing pink cartoon brain villain inside, small black dot eyes, thin neutral mouth, black spiky hair, blue t-shirt, gray pants. Brain villain: pink cartoon brain character, heavy-lidded eyes, slight smirk, small teeth. Palette: beige skin (#F5E6C8), pink brain (#E8A598), blue shirt, gray pants, green for savings/gains, red for loss/danger, white for diagram scenes. 16:9, 1280x720. Wide shot. A fuel gauge at center. Around it: small decision icons orbiting — a lunch menu, an email, a meeting conflict, a commute. Each icon drains the gauge slightly as it orbits.

BEAT 34 "Deciding what to eat for lunch draws from the same reserve as deciding not to spend the salary."

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BEAT 35 "By payday, Alex's reserve is nearly empty."

Image Prompt: 2D flat cartoon illustration, thick solid black outlines, clean solid color fills, no gradients. ALEX: large beige oval head, transparent glass upper skull revealing pink cartoon brain villain inside, small black dot eyes, thin neutral mouth, black spiky hair, blue t-shirt, gray pants. Brain villain: pink cartoon brain character, heavy-lidded eyes, slight smirk, small teeth. Palette: beige skin (#F5E6C8), pink brain (#E8A598), blue shirt, gray pants, green for savings/gains, red for loss/danger, white for diagram scenes. 16:9, 1280x720. Close-up of the gauge. Needle deep in red. A PAYDAY marker on the dial. Warning light on. The worst moment to need it.

BEAT 36 "His back hurts. His focus is gone. He's been patient all week."

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BEAT 37 "The moment he needs discipline most is the exact moment he has the least."

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BEAT 38 "A budget is a willpower machine."

Image Prompt: 2D flat cartoon illustration, thick solid black outlines, clean solid color fills, no gradients. ALEX: large beige oval head, transparent glass upper skull revealing pink cartoon brain villain inside, small black dot eyes, thin neutral mouth, black spiky hair, blue t-shirt, gray pants. Brain villain: pink cartoon brain character, heavy-lidded eyes, slight smirk, small teeth. Palette: beige skin (#F5E6C8), pink brain (#E8A598), blue shirt, gray pants, green for savings/gains, red for loss/danger, white for diagram scenes. 16:9, 1280x720. Wide shot. A budget spreadsheet icon reimagined as an industrial machine — gears, intake valve, a fuel pipe labeled WILLPOWER feeding it. The machine needs continuous fuel to run.

BEAT 39 "It asks Alex to make the right decision, at the right moment, every payday, for thirty years."

Image Prompt: 2D flat cartoon illustration, thick solid black outlines, clean solid color fills, no gradients. ALEX: large beige oval head, transparent glass upper skull revealing pink cartoon brain villain inside, small black dot eyes, thin neutral mouth, black spiky hair, blue t-shirt, gray pants. Brain villain: pink cartoon brain character, heavy-lidded eyes, slight smirk, small teeth. Palette: beige skin (#F5E6C8), pink brain (#E8A598), blue shirt, gray pants, green for savings/gains, red for loss/danger, white for diagram scenes. 16:9, 1280x720. Wide shot. A long calendar — 30 years of Fridays visible. Each payday has a small decision icon. In the corner, a counter climbs: 120... 240... 360. The scale becomes the problem.

BEAT 40 "The Brain Villain is patient. Willpower has a ceiling."

Image Prompt: 2D flat cartoon illustration, thick solid black outlines, clean solid color fills, no gradients. ALEX: large beige oval head, transparent glass upper skull revealing pink cartoon brain villain inside, small black dot eyes, thin neutral mouth, black spiky hair, blue t-shirt, gray pants. Brain villain: pink cartoon brain character, heavy-lidded eyes, slight smirk, small teeth. Palette: beige skin (#F5E6C8), pink brain (#E8A598), blue shirt, gray pants, green for savings/gains, red for loss/danger, white for diagram scenes. 16:9, 1280x720. Medium shot, waiting room. Villain in a comfortable chair — unhurried, arms folded. A clock on the wall. Above: a physical glass ceiling. Villain knows the math. It can wait.

BEAT 41 "Over thirty years, the math does not favor Alex."

Image Prompt: 2D flat cartoon illustration, thick solid black outlines, clean solid color fills, no gradients. ALEX: large beige oval head, transparent glass upper skull revealing pink cartoon brain villain inside, small black dot eyes, thin neutral mouth, black spiky hair, blue t-shirt, gray pants. Brain villain: pink cartoon brain character, heavy-lidded eyes, slight smirk, small teeth. Palette: beige skin (#F5E6C8), pink brain (#E8A598), blue shirt, gray pants, green for savings/gains, red for loss/danger, white for diagram scenes. 16:9, 1280x720. Wide diagram. Two lines across a 30-year span. TOP line: flat and unbroken (villain's patience — permanent). BOTTOM line: erratic, periodically recovering but never consistent (Alex's willpower). After 30 years, villain's line is unbroken.

■■ THE DECISION ■■

BEAT 42 "There is only one way to beat a system that runs automatically."

Image Prompt: 2D flat cartoon illustration, thick solid black outlines, clean solid color fills, no gradients. ALEX: large beige oval head, transparent glass upper skull revealing pink cartoon brain villain inside, small black dot eyes, thin neutral mouth, black spiky hair, blue t-shirt, gray pants. Brain villain: pink cartoon brain character, heavy-lidded eyes, slight smirk, small teeth. Palette: beige skin (#F5E6C8), pink brain (#E8A598), blue shirt, gray pants, green for savings/gains, red for loss/danger, white for diagram scenes. 16:9, 1280x720. Wide shot, white background. Three trap gears spinning — the automatic system. Below them: a large question mark forming, growing.

BEAT 43 "Build a counter-system that also runs automatically."

Image Prompt: 2D flat cartoon illustration, thick solid black outlines, clean solid color fills, no gradients. ALEX: large beige oval head, transparent glass upper skull revealing pink cartoon brain villain inside, small black dot eyes, thin neutral mouth, black spiky hair, blue t-shirt, gray pants. Brain villain: pink cartoon brain character, heavy-lidded eyes, slight smirk, small teeth. Palette: beige skin (#F5E6C8), pink brain (#E8A598), blue shirt, gray pants, green for savings/gains, red for loss/danger, white for diagram scenes. 16:9, 1280x720. Wide shot. A new green gear enters from the left — single, clean. It does not fight the three trap gears. It slots in BEFORE them on the timeline. It runs first.

BEAT 44 "Alex set up a standing order."

Image Prompt: 2D flat cartoon illustration, thick solid black outlines, clean solid color fills, no gradients. ALEX: large beige oval head, transparent glass upper skull revealing pink cartoon brain villain inside, small black dot eyes, thin neutral mouth, black spiky hair, blue t-shirt, gray pants. Brain villain: pink cartoon brain character, heavy-lidded eyes, slight smirk, small teeth. Palette: beige skin (#F5E6C8), pink brain (#E8A598), blue shirt, gray pants, green for savings/gains, red for loss/danger, white for diagram scenes. 16:9, 1280x720. Medium shot. Alex at his laptop on a Sunday morning. Relaxed — coffee nearby, no Friday exhaustion. Bank transfer form on screen. Villain: absent from skull entirely. This decision happens in silence.

BEAT 45 "Four hundred euros. Every payday. Before he sees the balance."

Image Prompt: 2D flat cartoon illustration, thick solid black outlines, clean solid color fills, no gradients. ALEX: large beige oval head, transparent glass upper skull revealing pink cartoon brain villain inside, small black dot eyes, thin neutral mouth, black spiky hair, blue t-shirt, gray pants. Brain villain: pink cartoon brain character, heavy-lidded eyes, slight smirk, small teeth. Palette: beige skin (#F5E6C8), pink brain (#E8A598), blue shirt, gray pants, green for savings/gains, red for loss/danger, white for diagram scenes. 16:9, 1280x720. Close-up of laptop screen. Bank transfer form: €400 in amount field. RECURRING selected. Date: payday minus one day. Cursor on CONFIRM. Three clean fields. Nothing else.

BEAT 46 "Before the Reward Trap can ask what he earned."

Image Prompt: 2D flat cartoon illustration, thick solid black outlines, clean solid color fills, no gradients. ALEX: large beige oval head, transparent glass upper skull revealing pink cartoon brain villain inside, small black dot eyes, thin neutral mouth, black spiky hair, blue t-shirt, gray pants. Brain villain: pink cartoon brain character, heavy-lidded eyes, slight smirk, small teeth. Palette: beige skin (#F5E6C8), pink brain (#E8A598), blue shirt, gray pants, green for savings/gains, red for loss/danger, white for diagram scenes. 16:9, 1280x720. Medium shot. The Reward Trap gear (red) beginning to spin as salary notification arrives. A green checkmark appears one beat before it — transfer already complete. The trap gear spins into empty space.

BEAT 47 "Before Mental Accounting creates a label for it."

Image Prompt: 2D flat cartoon illustration, thick solid black outlines, clean solid color fills, no gradients. ALEX: large beige oval head, transparent glass upper skull revealing pink cartoon brain villain inside, small black dot eyes, thin neutral mouth, black spiky hair, blue t-shirt, gray pants. Brain villain: pink cartoon brain character, heavy-lidded eyes, slight smirk, small teeth. Palette: beige skin (#F5E6C8), pink brain (#E8A598), blue shirt, gray pants, green for savings/gains, red for loss/danger, white for diagram scenes. 16:9, 1280x720. Medium shot. Mental Accounting's labeling mechanism about to run. The standing order already moved the money. The labeler idles — nothing to process.

BEAT 48 "Before Present Bias tells him Future Alex will handle it."

Image Prompt: 2D flat cartoon illustration, thick solid black outlines, clean solid color fills, no gradients. ALEX: large beige oval head, transparent glass upper skull revealing pink cartoon brain villain inside, small black dot eyes, thin neutral mouth, black spiky hair, blue t-shirt, gray pants. Brain villain: pink cartoon brain character, heavy-lidded eyes, slight smirk, small teeth. Palette: beige skin (#F5E6C8), pink brain (#E8A598), blue shirt, gray pants, green for savings/gains, red for loss/danger, white for diagram scenes. 16:9, 1280x720. Medium shot. Future Alex silhouette in the distance — the usual recipient of deferrals. The deferral signal arrives with nothing attached. Future Alex holds up empty hands.

BEAT 49 *"The Reward Trap fires the moment the salary notification arrives. The standing order fires one minute earlier."*

Image Prompt: 2D flat cartoon illustration, thick solid black outlines, clean solid color fills, no gradients. ALEX: large beige oval head, transparent glass upper skull revealing pink cartoon brain villain inside, small black dot eyes, thin neutral mouth, black spiky hair, blue t-shirt, gray pants. Brain villain: pink cartoon brain character, heavy-lidded eyes, slight smirk, small teeth. Palette: beige skin (#F5E6C8), pink brain (#E8A598), blue shirt, gray pants, green for savings/gains, red for loss/danger, white for diagram scenes. 16:9, 1280x720. Wide timeline. Three points on the line: STANDING ORDER at 9:13 (green, leftmost). SALARY ARRIVES at 9:14 (blue). REWARD TRAP FIRES at 9:14 (red, same position as salary). Green arrow under 9:13: it was here first.

BEAT 50 *"Mental Accounting creates emotional categories — labels that make spending feel logical. The standing order creates one category the Brain Villain is never shown."*

Image Prompt: 2D flat cartoon illustration, thick solid black outlines, clean solid color fills, no gradients. ALEX: large beige oval head, transparent glass upper skull revealing pink cartoon brain villain inside, small black dot eyes, thin neutral mouth, black spiky hair, blue t-shirt, gray pants. Brain villain: pink cartoon brain character, heavy-lidded eyes, slight smirk, small teeth. Palette: beige skin (#F5E6C8), pink brain (#E8A598), blue shirt, gray pants, green for savings/gains, red for loss/danger, white for diagram scenes. 16:9, 1280x720. Wide shot. Mental Accounting's visible category boxes — SALARY, REWARDS, SPENDING MONEY — all in villain's line of sight. Then one additional box, separated, slightly off-frame: no path connecting villain to it. Unreachable by design.

BEAT 51 *"Present Bias says Future Alex will be disciplined. Past Alex already was — nine days ago, when he was calm, rested, and the villain was quiet."*

Image Prompt: 2D flat cartoon illustration, thick solid black outlines, clean solid color fills, no gradients. ALEX: large beige oval head, transparent glass upper skull revealing pink cartoon brain villain inside, small black dot eyes, thin neutral mouth, black spiky hair, blue t-shirt, gray pants. Brain villain: pink cartoon brain character, heavy-lidded eyes, slight smirk, small teeth. Palette: beige skin (#F5E6C8), pink brain (#E8A598), blue shirt, gray pants, green for savings/gains, red for loss/danger, white for diagram scenes. 16:9, 1280x720. Wide shot. Three Alex versions in one frame. FUTURE ALEX: distant, confident wave. PRESENT ALEX: Friday, depleted, open wallet. PAST ALEX: Sunday morning, laptop, transfer confirmed, calm, villain absent. A bold arrow from Past Alex forward to payday.

BEAT 52 *"Alex didn't learn to say no to the Brain Villain. He cancelled the meeting."*

Image Prompt: 2D flat cartoon illustration, thick solid black outlines, clean solid color fills, no gradients. ALEX: large beige oval head, transparent glass upper skull revealing pink cartoon brain villain inside, small black dot eyes, thin neutral mouth, black spiky hair, blue t-shirt, gray pants. Brain villain: pink cartoon brain character, heavy-lidded eyes, slight smirk, small teeth. Palette: beige skin (#F5E6C8), pink brain (#E8A598), blue shirt, gray pants, green for savings/gains, red for loss/danger, white for diagram scenes. 16:9, 1280x720. Wide shot, meeting room. Villain at the table — notepad open, arguments prepared, ready to negotiate. Alex is not there. On the door: a MEETING CANCELLED notice. The villain sits alone in an empty room.

BEAT 53 *"The Brain Villain cannot fight a decision it was never invited to attend."*

Image Prompt: 2D flat cartoon illustration, thick solid black outlines, clean solid color fills, no gradients. ALEX: large beige oval head, transparent glass upper skull revealing pink cartoon brain villain inside, small black dot eyes, thin neutral mouth, black spiky hair, blue t-shirt, gray pants. Brain villain: pink cartoon brain character, heavy-lidded eyes, slight smirk, small teeth. Palette: beige skin (#F5E6C8), pink brain (#E8A598), blue shirt, gray pants, green for savings/gains, red for loss/danger, white for diagram scenes. 16:9, 1280x720. Close-up at the meeting table. Villain's notepad of arguments open — useless. A cancelled invitation on the table beside it. Villain expression: rare confusion.

BEAT 54 *"The money is simply not there to be calculated."*

Image Prompt: 2D flat cartoon illustration, thick solid black outlines, clean solid color fills, no gradients. ALEX: large beige oval head, transparent glass upper skull revealing pink cartoon brain villain inside, small black dot eyes, thin neutral mouth, black spiky hair, blue t-shirt, gray pants. Brain villain: pink cartoon brain character, heavy-lidded eyes, slight smirk, small teeth. Palette: beige skin (#F5E6C8), pink brain (#E8A598), blue shirt, gray pants, green for savings/gains, red for loss/danger, white for diagram scenes. 16:9, 1280x720. Medium shot. Alex's account balance on screen. The €400 absent — a completed transfer line, not a loss. Villain leans in to calculate. Finds nothing. Expression: can't compute.

■■■ CTA ■■■

BEAT 55 *"If your brain is running these programs right now — subscribe."*

Image Prompt: 2D flat cartoon illustration, thick solid black outlines, clean solid color fills, no gradients. ALEX: large beige oval head, transparent glass upper skull revealing pink cartoon brain villain inside, small black dot eyes, thin neutral mouth, black spiky hair, blue t-shirt, gray pants. Brain villain: pink cartoon brain character, heavy-lidded eyes, slight smirk, small teeth. Palette: beige skin (#F5E6C8), pink brain (#E8A598), blue shirt, gray pants, green for savings/gains, red for loss/danger, white for diagram scenes. 16:9, 1280x720. Medium shot. Alex turns to camera. Direct, calm. Villain freezes behind him — caught mid-operation, hand stuck forward.

BEAT 56 "Every week: one bias. How it works. Who exploits it. And what you can actually do about it."

Image Prompt: 2D flat cartoon illustration, thick solid black outlines, clean solid color fills, no gradients. ALEX: large beige oval head, transparent glass upper skull revealing pink cartoon brain villain inside, small black dot eyes, thin neutral mouth, black spiky hair, blue t-shirt, gray pants. Brain villain: pink cartoon brain character, heavy-lidded eyes, slight smirk, small teeth. Palette: beige skin (#F5E6C8), pink brain (#E8A598), blue shirt, gray pants, green for savings/gains, red for loss/danger, white for diagram scenes. 16:9, 1280x720. Medium shot continues. Villain rolls its eyes. Alex turns back. Hard cut.

■■ THE SCIENCE ■■

BEAT 57 "Richard Thaler and Shlomo Benartzi — University of Chicago and UCLA, 2004 —"

Image Prompt: 2D flat cartoon illustration, thick solid black outlines, clean solid color fills, no gradients. ALEX: large beige oval head, transparent glass upper skull revealing pink cartoon brain villain inside, small black dot eyes, thin neutral mouth, black spiky hair, blue t-shirt, gray pants. Brain villain: pink cartoon brain character, heavy-lidded eyes, slight smirk, small teeth. Palette: beige skin (#F5E6C8), pink brain (#E8A598), blue shirt, gray pants, green for savings/gains, red for loss/danger, white for diagram scenes. 16:9, 1280x720. Wide shot, academic setting. Two cartoon figures side by side: THALER (professorial, University of Chicago banner) and BENARTZI (analytical, UCLA banner). Label: 'THALER + BENARTZI · 2004.'

BEAT 58 "designed a program called Save More Tomorrow."

Image Prompt: 2D flat cartoon illustration, thick solid black outlines, clean solid color fills, no gradients. ALEX: large beige oval head, transparent glass upper skull revealing pink cartoon brain villain inside, small black dot eyes, thin neutral mouth, black spiky hair, blue t-shirt, gray pants. Brain villain: pink cartoon brain character, heavy-lidded eyes, slight smirk, small teeth. Palette: beige skin (#F5E6C8), pink brain (#E8A598), blue shirt, gray pants, green for savings/gains, red for loss/danger, white for diagram scenes. 16:9, 1280x720. Wide shot. A clean program icon: SAVE MORE TOMORROW. The name deliberately paradoxical. A small calendar icon beside it — the delay is the mechanism.

BEAT 59 "They didn't ask workers to save more now."

Image Prompt: 2D flat cartoon illustration, thick solid black outlines, clean solid color fills, no gradients. ALEX: large beige oval head, transparent glass upper skull revealing pink cartoon brain villain inside, small black dot eyes, thin neutral mouth, black spiky hair, blue t-shirt, gray pants. Brain villain: pink cartoon brain character, heavy-lidded eyes, slight smirk, small teeth. Palette: beige skin (#F5E6C8), pink brain (#E8A598), blue shirt, gray pants, green for savings/gains, red for loss/danger, white for diagram scenes. 16:9, 1280x720. Wide shot. A conventional save-now prompt — a YES/NO checkbox form. Workers crossing it out, walking past, shaking heads. Villain nodding in satisfaction — this approach fails as expected.

BEAT 60 "They asked one question: when your next raise comes, can we automatically redirect a fixed percentage?"

Image Prompt: 2D flat cartoon illustration, thick solid black outlines, clean solid color fills, no gradients. ALEX: large beige oval head, transparent glass upper skull revealing pink cartoon brain villain inside, small black dot eyes, thin neutral mouth, black spiky hair, blue t-shirt, gray pants. Brain villain: pink cartoon brain character, heavy-lidded eyes, slight smirk, small teeth. Palette: beige skin (#F5E6C8), pink brain (#E8A598), blue shirt, gray pants, green for savings/gains, red for loss/danger, white for diagram scenes. 16:9, 1280x720. Wide shot. A single clean question on a simple form. Workers looking at it, considering. Villain in the corner — not alarmed. It doesn't see a threat because nothing is happening right now.

PART 2 DONE — Beats 31–60 ✓

IMAGE PROMPTS — PART 3 (Beats 61–89)

BEAT 61 "Workers said yes — once."

Image Prompt: 2D flat cartoon illustration, thick solid black outlines, clean solid color fills, no gradients. ALEX: large beige oval head, transparent glass upper skull revealing pink cartoon brain villain inside, small black dot eyes, thin neutral mouth, black spiky hair, blue t-shirt, gray pants. Brain villain: pink cartoon brain character, heavy-lidded eyes, slight smirk, small teeth. Palette: beige skin (#F5E6C8), pink brain (#E8A598), blue shirt, gray pants, green for savings/gains, red for loss/danger, white for diagram scenes. 16:9, 1280x720. Close-up of a form. One checkbox: checked. One signature. The form is closed and slid into a drawer. Done. Nothing more required.

BEAT 62 "The system executed automatically, every raise cycle, with no further decisions required."

Image Prompt: 2D flat cartoon illustration, thick solid black outlines, clean solid color fills, no gradients. ALEX: large beige oval head, transparent glass upper skull revealing pink cartoon brain villain inside, small black dot eyes, thin neutral mouth, black spiky hair, blue t-shirt, gray pants. Brain villain: pink cartoon brain character, heavy-lidded eyes, slight smirk, small teeth. Palette: beige skin (#F5E6C8), pink brain (#E8A598), blue shirt, gray pants, green for savings/gains, red for loss/danger, white for diagram scenes. 16:9, 1280x720. Wide diagram. A raise cycle timeline: YEAR 1 → YEAR 2 → YEAR 3 → YEAR 4 → YEAR 5. Each year: a raise arrives, a percentage auto-redirects. A small auto-execute symbol at each step. No human figure involved.

BEAT 63 "Workers who started at a savings rate of three and a half percent"

Image Prompt: 2D flat cartoon illustration, thick solid black outlines, clean solid color fills, no gradients. ALEX: large beige oval head, transparent glass upper skull revealing pink cartoon brain villain inside, small black dot eyes, thin neutral mouth, black spiky hair, blue t-shirt, gray pants. Brain villain: pink cartoon brain character, heavy-lidded eyes, slight smirk, small teeth. Palette: beige skin (#F5E6C8), pink brain (#E8A598), blue shirt, gray pants, green for savings/gains, red for loss/danger, white for diagram scenes. 16:9, 1280x720. Wide shot, bar chart. One bar: 3.5% — small, with '3.5%' label. This is where most people stay.

BEAT 64 "reached thirteen point six percent within five years."

Image Prompt: 2D flat cartoon illustration, thick solid black outlines, clean solid color fills, no gradients. ALEX: large beige oval head, transparent glass upper skull revealing pink cartoon brain villain inside, small black dot eyes, thin neutral mouth, black spiky hair, blue t-shirt, gray pants. Brain villain: pink cartoon brain character, heavy-lidded eyes, slight smirk, small teeth. Palette: beige skin (#F5E6C8), pink brain (#E8A598), blue shirt, gray pants, green for savings/gains, red for loss/danger, white for diagram scenes. 16:9, 1280x720. Same chart. The bar rises dramatically to 13.6% — nearly four times taller. A small time marker: '5 YRS.' The '13.6%' label at the top of the bar. Nothing else.

BEAT 65 "No budgets. No discipline. No willpower."

Image Prompt: 2D flat cartoon illustration, thick solid black outlines, clean solid color fills, no gradients. ALEX: large beige oval head, transparent glass upper skull revealing pink cartoon brain villain inside, small black dot eyes, thin neutral mouth, black spiky hair, blue t-shirt, gray pants. Brain villain: pink cartoon brain character, heavy-lidded eyes, slight smirk, small teeth. Palette: beige skin (#F5E6C8), pink brain (#E8A598), blue shirt, gray pants, green for savings/gains, red for loss/danger, white for diagram scenes. 16:9, 1280x720. Wide shot, white background. Three icons, each X'd out: budget spreadsheet, flexing arm, effort figure. Clean. The absence is the message.

BEAT 66 "One structural decision replaced sixty monthly battles with the Brain Villain."

Image Prompt: 2D flat cartoon illustration, thick solid black outlines, clean solid color fills, no gradients. ALEX: large beige oval head, transparent glass upper skull revealing pink cartoon brain villain inside, small black dot eyes, thin neutral mouth, black spiky hair, blue t-shirt, gray pants. Brain villain: pink cartoon brain character, heavy-lidded eyes, slight smirk, small teeth. Palette: beige skin (#F5E6C8), pink brain (#E8A598), blue shirt, gray pants, green for savings/gains, red for loss/danger, white for diagram scenes. 16:9, 1280x720. Wide comparison. LEFT: 60 small battle icons — dense, clustered, exhausting. RIGHT: ONE standing order icon — clean, single, already set. A bold equals sign between them.

BEAT 67 "The only variable was structure."

Image Prompt: 2D flat cartoon illustration, thick solid black outlines, clean solid color fills, no gradients. ALEX: large beige oval head, transparent glass upper skull revealing pink cartoon brain villain inside, small black dot eyes, thin neutral mouth, black spiky hair, blue t-shirt, gray pants. Brain villain: pink cartoon brain character, heavy-lidded eyes, slight smirk, small teeth. Palette: beige skin (#F5E6C8), pink brain (#E8A598), blue shirt, gray pants, green for savings/gains, red for loss/danger, white for diagram scenes. 16:9, 1280x720. Wide shot, white background. Villain staring at the standing order icon. Its usual weapons scattered on the floor unused: a temptation flag, an urgency alarm, a persuasion notepad. All useless. Villain expression: out of arguments.

■■■ BRAIN VILLAIN'S LAST TRICK ■■■

BEAT 68 "The Brain Villain has one response to automation."

Image Prompt: 2D flat cartoon illustration, thick solid black outlines, clean solid color fills, no gradients. ALEX: large beige oval head, transparent glass upper skull revealing pink cartoon brain villain inside, small black dot eyes, thin neutral mouth, black spiky hair, blue t-shirt, gray pants. Brain villain: pink cartoon brain character, heavy-lidded eyes, slight smirk, small teeth. Palette: beige skin (#F5E6C8), pink brain (#E8A598), blue shirt, gray pants, green for savings/gains, red for loss/danger, white for diagram scenes. 16:9, 1280x720. Medium shot. Villain — usually smug — now with a different expression: calculating. Looking at the standing order setup. Its usual playbook isn't working. Something new is forming.

BEAT 69 "It generates a feeling Alex can't immediately name: this doesn't feel safe."

Image Prompt: 2D flat cartoon illustration, thick solid black outlines, clean solid color fills, no gradients. ALEX: large beige oval head, transparent glass upper skull revealing pink cartoon brain villain inside, small black dot eyes, thin neutral mouth, black spiky hair, blue t-shirt, gray pants. Brain villain: pink cartoon brain character, heavy-lidded eyes, slight smirk, small teeth. Palette: beige skin (#F5E6C8), pink brain (#E8A598), blue shirt, gray pants, green for savings/gains, red for loss/danger, white for diagram scenes. 16:9, 1280x720. Close-up inside Alex's skull. Villain holds a sign — but the sign is deliberately BLANK, no text. A soft mist inside the skull. Alex's expression: uneasy, unable to identify the source.

BEAT 70 "Alex looks at the standing order and thinks: what if I need that money?"

Image Prompt: 2D flat cartoon illustration, thick solid black outlines, clean solid color fills, no gradients. ALEX: large beige oval head, transparent glass upper skull revealing pink cartoon brain villain inside, small black dot eyes, thin neutral mouth, black spiky hair, blue t-shirt, gray pants. Brain villain: pink cartoon brain character, heavy-lidded eyes, slight smirk, small teeth. Palette: beige skin (#F5E6C8), pink brain (#E8A598), blue shirt, gray pants, green for savings/gains, red for loss/danger, white for diagram scenes. 16:9, 1280x720. Medium shot. Alex at laptop, standing order confirmed. A thought bubble forms above him — warm amber tone (Present Bias color from V11). Villain in corner: nodding slowly, satisfied.

BEAT 71 "This is Present Bias wearing a different costume."

Image Prompt: 2D flat cartoon illustration, thick solid black outlines, clean solid color fills, no gradients. ALEX: large beige oval head, transparent glass upper skull revealing pink cartoon brain villain inside, small black dot eyes, thin neutral mouth, black spiky hair, blue t-shirt, gray pants. Brain villain: pink cartoon brain character, heavy-lidded eyes, slight smirk, small teeth. Palette: beige skin (#F5E6C8), pink brain (#E8A598), blue shirt, gray pants, green for savings/gains, red for loss/danger, white for diagram scenes. 16:9, 1280x720. Wide shot. The familiar Present Bias mechanism from V11 — but now wearing a mask. The mask label: SAFETY CONCERN. A hand lifts the mask to reveal: same gear underneath, same mechanism, identical.

BEAT 72 "It's not about the money. It's about the option."

Image Prompt: 2D flat cartoon illustration, thick solid black outlines, clean solid color fills, no gradients. ALEX: large beige oval head, transparent glass upper skull revealing pink cartoon brain villain inside, small black dot eyes, thin neutral mouth, black spiky hair, blue t-shirt, gray pants. Brain villain: pink cartoon brain character, heavy-lidded eyes, slight smirk, small teeth. Palette: beige skin (#F5E6C8), pink brain (#E8A598), blue shirt, gray pants, green for savings/gains, red for loss/danger, white for diagram scenes. 16:9, 1280x720. Wide shot. Two columns. LEFT: a stack of money (the euros themselves). RIGHT: an open door with a handle — the option to open it. An arrow points exclusively to the RIGHT column.

BEAT 73 "The Brain Villain doesn't need to spend it. It just needs to know it could."

Image Prompt: 2D flat cartoon illustration, thick solid black outlines, clean solid color fills, no gradients. ALEX: large beige oval head, transparent glass upper skull revealing pink cartoon brain villain inside, small black dot eyes, thin neutral mouth, black spiky hair, blue t-shirt, gray pants. Brain villain: pink cartoon brain character, heavy-lidded eyes, slight smirk, small teeth. Palette: beige skin (#F5E6C8), pink brain (#E8A598), blue shirt, gray pants, green for savings/gains, red for loss/danger, white for diagram scenes. 16:9, 1280x720. Medium shot. Villain sitting beside an open bank account display — hand nearby but not touching. Not withdrawing. Just monitoring. Expression: the presence of optionality is enough.

BEAT 74 "The standing order removes the option."

Image Prompt: 2D flat cartoon illustration, thick solid black outlines, clean solid color fills, no gradients. ALEX: large beige oval head, transparent glass upper skull revealing pink cartoon brain villain inside, small black dot eyes, thin neutral mouth, black spiky hair, blue t-shirt, gray pants. Brain villain: pink cartoon brain character, heavy-lidded eyes, slight smirk, small teeth. Palette: beige skin (#F5E6C8), pink brain (#E8A598), blue shirt, gray pants, green for savings/gains, red for loss/danger, white for diagram scenes. 16:9, 1280x720. Close-up. Standing order fires. The €400 moves. Villain reaches for the space where the money was. Empty. Not a fight. Just absence.

BEAT 75 "That's exactly why it works. And exactly why the Brain Villain fights it."

Image Prompt: 2D flat cartoon illustration, thick solid black outlines, clean solid color fills, no gradients. ALEX: large beige oval head, transparent glass upper skull revealing pink cartoon brain villain inside, small black dot eyes, thin neutral mouth, black spiky hair, blue t-shirt, gray pants. Brain villain: pink cartoon brain character, heavy-lidded eyes, slight smirk, small teeth. Palette: beige skin (#F5E6C8), pink brain (#E8A598), blue shirt, gray pants, green for savings/gains, red for loss/danger, white for diagram scenes. 16:9, 1280x720. Medium shot. Villain — smaller now, less imposing — staring at the standing order on Alex's laptop. Expression: genuine discomfort. First time it has no move.

■■ IDENTITY CLOSE ■■

BEAT 76 "Alex doesn't need more discipline."

Image Prompt: 2D flat cartoon illustration, thick solid black outlines, clean solid color fills, no gradients. ALEX: large beige oval head, transparent glass upper skull revealing pink cartoon brain villain inside, small black dot eyes, thin neutral mouth, black spiky hair, blue t-shirt, gray pants. Brain villain: pink cartoon brain character, heavy-lidded eyes, slight smirk, small teeth. Palette: beige skin (#F5E6C8), pink brain (#E8A598), blue shirt, gray pants, green for savings/gains, red for loss/danger, white for diagram scenes. 16:9, 1280x720. Medium shot. Alex. Calm. Three trap gears visible in background — still spinning — but he is not fighting them. He stands beside his laptop, standing order running. No effort. No strain.

BEAT 77 "He needs fewer decisions — not better ones."

Image Prompt: 2D flat cartoon illustration, thick solid black outlines, clean solid color fills, no gradients. ALEX: large beige oval head, transparent glass upper skull revealing pink cartoon brain villain inside, small black dot eyes, thin neutral mouth, black spiky hair, blue t-shirt, gray pants. Brain villain: pink cartoon brain character, heavy-lidded eyes, slight smirk, small teeth. Palette: beige skin (#F5E6C8), pink brain (#E8A598), blue shirt, gray pants, green for savings/gains, red for loss/danger, white for diagram scenes. 16:9, 1280x720. Wide diagram. Two paths. LEFT: endless repetition of decision icons, human figure straining — red X. RIGHT: one decision point, then automatic, then nothing — green arrow forward.

BEAT 78 "Every budgeting system asks him to win the same battle every month."

Image Prompt: 2D flat cartoon illustration, thick solid black outlines, clean solid color fills, no gradients. ALEX: large beige oval head, transparent glass upper skull revealing pink cartoon brain villain inside, small black dot eyes, thin neutral mouth, black spiky hair, blue t-shirt, gray pants. Brain villain: pink cartoon brain character, heavy-lidded eyes, slight smirk, small teeth. Palette: beige skin (#F5E6C8), pink brain (#E8A598), blue shirt, gray pants, green for savings/gains, red for loss/danger, white for diagram scenes. 16:9, 1280x720. Wide shot. A year calendar — 12 months. Each month has a small confrontation icon: villain vs Alex, same fight, month after month. A count builds in the corner: 12. Then 120. Then 360.

BEAT 79 "The standing order asks him to win it once."

Image Prompt: 2D flat cartoon illustration, thick solid black outlines, clean solid color fills, no gradients. ALEX: large beige oval head, transparent glass upper skull revealing pink cartoon brain villain inside, small black dot eyes, thin neutral mouth, black spiky hair, blue t-shirt, gray pants. Brain villain: pink cartoon brain character, heavy-lidded eyes, slight smirk, small teeth. Palette: beige skin (#F5E6C8), pink brain (#E8A598), blue shirt, gray pants, green for savings/gains, red for loss/danger, white for diagram scenes. 16:9, 1280x720. Same calendar — but now 11 months are empty white. Only one month has a setup icon: a green checkmark. Eleven months of silence.

BEAT 80 "The Reward Trap fires on Friday. But the money is already gone."

Image Prompt: 2D flat cartoon illustration, thick solid black outlines, clean solid color fills, no gradients. ALEX: large beige oval head, transparent glass upper skull revealing pink cartoon brain villain inside, small black dot eyes, thin neutral mouth, black spiky hair, blue t-shirt, gray pants. Brain villain: pink cartoon brain character, heavy-lidded eyes, slight smirk, small teeth. Palette: beige skin (#F5E6C8), pink brain (#E8A598), blue shirt, gray pants, green for savings/gains, red for loss/danger, white for diagram scenes. 16:9, 1280x720. Medium shot. The Reward Trap gear fires — triggered by salary notification. It reaches for the €400. The space is empty. A completed transfer line where the money was.

BEAT 81 "Mental Accounting creates false categories. But there's now one it can never reach."

Image Prompt: 2D flat cartoon illustration, thick solid black outlines, clean solid color fills, no gradients. ALEX: large beige oval head, transparent glass upper skull revealing pink cartoon brain villain inside, small black dot eyes, thin neutral mouth, black spiky hair, blue t-shirt, gray pants. Brain villain: pink cartoon brain character, heavy-lidded eyes, slight smirk, small teeth. Palette: beige skin (#F5E6C8), pink brain (#E8A598), blue shirt, gray pants, green for savings/gains, red for loss/danger, white for diagram scenes. 16:9, 1280x720. Wide shot. Mental Accounting's category boxes — SALARY, REWARDS, SPENDING MONEY — all visible to villain. Then one box, separated, slightly out of frame. No path from the labeling machine to it.

BEAT 82 "Present Bias says Future Alex will be responsible. And this time — he already was."

Image Prompt: 2D flat cartoon illustration, thick solid black outlines, clean solid color fills, no gradients. ALEX: large beige oval head, transparent glass upper skull revealing pink cartoon brain villain inside, small black dot eyes, thin neutral mouth, black spiky hair, blue t-shirt, gray pants. Brain villain: pink cartoon brain character, heavy-lidded eyes, slight smirk, small teeth. Palette: beige skin (#F5E6C8), pink brain (#E8A598), blue shirt, gray pants, green for savings/gains, red for loss/danger, white for diagram scenes. 16:9, 1280x720. Wide shot. Present Bias deferral signal heading to Future Alex. But Past Alex (Sunday, calm, transfer confirmed) holds up a checkmark. Future Alex receives empty responsibility — nothing to do.

BEAT 83 "The programs are not broken."

Image Prompt: 2D flat cartoon illustration, thick solid black outlines, clean solid color fills, no gradients. ALEX: large beige oval head, transparent glass upper skull revealing pink cartoon brain villain inside, small black dot eyes, thin neutral mouth, black spiky hair, blue t-shirt, gray pants. Brain villain: pink cartoon brain character, heavy-lidded eyes, slight smirk, small teeth. Palette: beige skin (#F5E6C8), pink brain (#E8A598), blue shirt, gray pants, green for savings/gains, red for loss/danger, white for diagram scenes. 16:9, 1280x720. Wide shot. Three trap gears — but their labels change from trap names to their original evolutionary functions: MOTIVATION SYSTEM, CATEGORIZATION SYSTEM, IMMEDIATE THREAT RESPONSE. Clean and neutral.

BEAT 84 *"They are perfectly designed for an environment where saving made no survival sense."*

Image Prompt: 2D flat cartoon illustration, thick solid black outlines, clean solid color fills, no gradients. ALEX: large beige oval head, transparent glass upper skull revealing pink cartoon brain villain inside, small black dot eyes, thin neutral mouth, black spiky hair, blue t-shirt, gray pants. Brain villain: pink cartoon brain character, heavy-lidded eyes, slight smirk, small teeth. Palette: beige skin (#F5E6C8), pink brain (#E8A598), blue shirt, gray pants, green for savings/gains, red for loss/danger, white for diagram scenes. 16:9, 1280x720. Wide split shot. LEFT: sparse ancient landscape — immediate threats, no storage infrastructure. A figure surviving day to day. RIGHT: modern Alex — salary, bank account, compound interest. Same programs. Completely different world.

BEAT 85 *"The standing order is the first system Alex has ever used that was built for his world — not theirs."*

Image Prompt: 2D flat cartoon illustration, thick solid black outlines, clean solid color fills, no gradients. ALEX: large beige oval head, transparent glass upper skull revealing pink cartoon brain villain inside, small black dot eyes, thin neutral mouth, black spiky hair, blue t-shirt, gray pants. Brain villain: pink cartoon brain character, heavy-lidded eyes, slight smirk, small teeth. Palette: beige skin (#F5E6C8), pink brain (#E8A598), blue shirt, gray pants, green for savings/gains, red for loss/danger, white for diagram scenes. 16:9, 1280x720. Wide split panel. LEFT: ancient environment (spending immediately was survival). RIGHT: modern Alex with standing order running — built for compound interest, salary cycles, future self. Same brain. Different architecture.

■■ GUIDE ■■

BEAT 86 *"Next video: Alex gets a tax refund. Eight hundred euros he didn't expect."*

Image Prompt: 2D flat cartoon illustration, thick solid black outlines, clean solid color fills, no gradients. ALEX: large beige oval head, transparent glass upper skull revealing pink cartoon brain villain inside, small black dot eyes, thin neutral mouth, black spiky hair, blue t-shirt, gray pants. Brain villain: pink cartoon brain character, heavy-lidded eyes, slight smirk, small teeth. Palette: beige skin (#F5E6C8), pink brain (#E8A598), blue shirt, gray pants, green for savings/gains, red for loss/danger, white for diagram scenes. 16:9, 1280x720. Medium shot. Alex's phone shows a NEW notification — different color from the salary notification, different energy: TAX REFUND RECEIVED — 800. Alex's expression: something is different. Villain activates with a different, faster pattern.

BEAT 87 *"His brain treats it completely differently from every euro he ever earned."*

Image Prompt: 2D flat cartoon illustration, thick solid black outlines, clean solid color fills, no gradients. ALEX: large beige oval head, transparent glass upper skull revealing pink cartoon brain villain inside, small black dot eyes, thin neutral mouth, black spiky hair, blue t-shirt, gray pants. Brain villain: pink cartoon brain character, heavy-lidded eyes, slight smirk, small teeth. Palette: beige skin (#F5E6C8), pink brain (#E8A598), blue shirt, gray pants, green for savings/gains, red for loss/danger, white for diagram scenes. 16:9, 1280x720. Close-up inside skull. Villain's response to the tax refund: visibly faster, larger, more urgent than the salary response. Different trigger. Different speed.

BEAT 88 *"Same trap. Different label. The refund disappears three times faster."*

Image Prompt: 2D flat cartoon illustration, thick solid black outlines, clean solid color fills, no gradients. ALEX: large beige oval head, transparent glass upper skull revealing pink cartoon brain villain inside, small black dot eyes, thin neutral mouth, black spiky hair, blue t-shirt, gray pants. Brain villain: pink cartoon brain character, heavy-lidded eyes, slight smirk, small teeth. Palette: beige skin (#F5E6C8), pink brain (#E8A598), blue shirt, gray pants, green for savings/gains, red for loss/danger, white for diagram scenes. 16:9, 1280x720. Wide bar chart comparison. LEFT: SALARY spend rate — moderate, spread over days. RIGHT: TAX REFUND (same amount) — spend rate three times faster, consumed in hours. The bars tell the story without words.

BEAT 89 *"And the reason is the one nobody expects."*

Image Prompt: 2D flat cartoon illustration, thick solid black outlines, clean solid color fills, no gradients. ALEX: large beige oval head, transparent glass upper skull revealing pink cartoon brain villain inside, small black dot eyes, thin neutral mouth, black spiky hair, blue t-shirt, gray pants. Brain villain: pink cartoon brain character, heavy-lidded eyes, slight smirk, small teeth. Palette: beige skin (#F5E6C8), pink brain (#E8A598), blue shirt, gray pants, green for savings/gains, red for loss/danger, white for diagram scenes. 16:9, 1280x720. Wide shot, white background. Three familiar trap icons visible. A fourth element emerges — partially revealed, a question mark covering it. A new label forming but incomplete. Villain gives a slow, reluctant nod. End screen appears in corner.

PART 3 DONE — Beats 61–89 ✓